

Chapter 30-1

The actress had a beautiful figure, with a toned stomach without a trace of excess flesh, large breasts, a perky bottom, and slender legs.

The chandelier cast warm yellow light, refracting streams of light like spinning radiance, everywhere permeated with ambiguity and sensuality.

One bed, two people, gazing at each other, their voices gradually changing tone.

The director filmed all the parts that should have been cut away, without any concealment.

From fingers to lips, until finally holding hands, sinking together into desire.

Every detail spoke of lust, yet expressed it so cleanly.

This was perhaps the high realm of art films.

The filming style was very similar to the one Liang Shi had watched that day, both with dimly dark tones, their love extreme and passionate.

Only Liang Shi hadn't felt anything when watching that night, but tonight she felt restless heat spreading from her lower abdomen.

She quietly glanced sideways. Xu Qingzhu's expression was calm, holding a cup of milk and sipping it lightly.

Inexplicably, Liang Shi thought of the scene from the movie—the maid licking a lollipop.

What happened after that?

After that was a restrained yet lingering kiss.

Xu Qingzhu's lips were full, appearing very pink under the warm yellow light, but unlike the natural pale pink lips of young girls, they were more like a mix of rose and strawberry colors.

A trace of milky white stained the corner of her lips.

She seemed to notice it herself, slowly extending her tongue tip, which lightly hooked and swallowed all that milky white trace.

Liang Shi unconsciously swallowed.

She stiffly turned her face away, suddenly thinking that such a tongue tip could probably easily tie cherries in knots.

...

Liang Shi shook her head, feeling that such thoughts were too indecent.

How could she fantasize about Xu Qingzhu?

But the movie was playing such explicit content, and beside her sat a cold beauty—it was difficult not to have improper thoughts.

Liang Shi usually didn't focus on such things, but that didn't mean she could completely abandon physiological needs.

She was probably a gentleman, but hadn't yet evolved to the saintly level of remaining unmoved while holding beauty in her arms.

She picked up the remote, her hand trembling, unable to hide her embarrassment as she asked, "Should we turn it off?"

Xu Qingzhu glanced at her hand, "Why are you shaking?"

Liang Shi: "..."

After two seconds of silence, Liang Shi said, "This is a bit too explicit."

"You just said that if there's anything in here, I should appreciate it from an artistic perspective." Xu Qingzhu took another sip of milk, her expression calm, "I think it's filmed quite artistically."

If you listened carefully, you could hear her voice trembling at the end.

And her hand holding the milk cup pressed heavily on it, her fingernails turning white.

Liang Shi didn't know what to do for a moment.

Fortunately, the shot cut to a distant view, becoming an empty shot of the room, leaving only the continuous, alternating gasps of the two female leads echoing in the room. Liang Shi breathed a sigh of relief, feeling that this face-heating scene had finally ended, but before she could fully relax, the room door was suddenly opened.

...?

Xu Qingya ran in breathlessly, her voice still carrying a crying tone, "Sister Liang, stop..."

Her voice overlapped with the sounds from the movie. When she stopped to catch her breath, she heard the satisfied sigh of the female lead in the movie as she released her desire.

Xu Qingya was instantly stunned, forgetting what she wanted to say.

Embarrassed from her toes to her hair, her scalp tingling.

She wanted to hold her breath, but couldn't help it and coughed several times.

Both Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu were stunned, but Xu Qingzhu reacted first, asking openly and honestly, "What's wrong?"

Xu Qingya: "..."

She forcefully covered her mouth, distorting her face as she rubbed it, immediately closed the door, and asked incoherently, "Don't mind me!"

The door was closed, and the room returned to silence.

But it was an eerie silence.

The movie had already cut to a different scene, and the BGM had become soothing.

Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu's eyes met.

Xu Qingzhu got up and put on her shoes, "I'll go see what's wrong with her."

Liang Shi immediately turned off the projector.

Seeing this, Xu Qingzhu took the time to ask, "Not watching anymore?"

Liang Shi: "..."

Still watch?

She secretly wiped the sweat from her forehead and nose, "No... not anymore."

Her speech was inevitably stuttering, rather like the embarrassment of being caught reading flashy comics during class by the teacher.

No, this was even more embarrassing.

At least when reading comics, she hadn't reacted physically—she was just purely looking, occasionally commenting that the artist's drawing was mediocre, purely to cater to male fans.

That was just a sense of shame and the humiliated emotion of being dragged out in public, unable to save face.

But at this moment, she was genuinely immersed emotionally, more difficult to bear than when she first transmigrated and was attracted by the Omega's pheromones, wanting to mark her and share in the feast of desire.

At least that was only physical torment, requiring endurance of just one aspect.

But this was double torment of both body and mind.

Liang Shi looked at the now-empty bed and sighed softly.

Being human, why make things difficult for yourself?

But... why did the butler buy this kind of movie?

Really!

Footnotes:

1. **信息素 (pheromones)** - In the ABO (Alpha/Beta/Omega) universe setting, these are chemical signals that affect attraction and behavior between different secondary genders.
 2. **标记 (mark)** - In ABO dynamics, this refers to a permanent bond created when an Alpha bites an Omega's scent gland, establishing a lifelong connection.
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Author's Note: This appears to be part of a larger narrative involving characters in an ABO (Alpha/Beta/Omega) alternate universe romance setting.

Chapter 30-2

Liang Shi wiped her sweat and went to the bathroom.

Her body had been aroused with desire but had found no relief. She spent a slightly longer time in the bathroom, taking the opportunity to calm her emotions. When she stood up again, her legs were still somewhat weak, desperately craving to do something.

She turned on the faucet, adjusting the water temperature to the coldest setting, washing away the dampness from her palms before splashing water on her face.

Her thoughts finally returned to rationality.

The cold water didn't completely wash away the flush from her face, and her ears still retained traces of having been moved to passion.

Looking at herself in the mirror, Liang Shi couldn't help but smile bitterly.

What was the point?

She'd be a pig if she did this kind of thing again!

Xu Qingzhu was maintaining her chaste composure, feeling at ease with her, but what about herself?

She had been stirred to the point of not knowing what to do, yet couldn't do anything about it.

Liang Shi immediately decided that in the future, if she wanted to watch movies, she would definitely go to the cinema and watch animated films.

Absolutely no romantic films.

And also, suspense films.

What the hell was that?

Why did suspense films all have such large scales?

This wasn't scientific.

After Liang Shi's mood had calmed down somewhat, she unconsciously scratched her hand again. The dense red rash on her hand seemed to be reminding her—she was having an allergic reaction.

Liang Shi rolled up her pajama sleeves and discovered that her arms were also covered in dense red bumps, to a degree that would frighten people with trypophobia¹.

Even the area below her collarbone had them, though not as densely packed as on her arms and hands.

These small red bumps were itchy. Initially they didn't hurt, but now that she had been scratching them for so long, that patch of skin was stinging.

Liang Shi frowned, thinking about what she had eaten that day.

She herself was allergic to green peppers, so she never touched them.

After eating green peppers, she would have a similar reaction, so she suspected whether she had inadvertently consumed green peppers.

But she quickly recalled everything she had eaten throughout the day—no green peppers.

So she suspected it was the water in the swimming pool that evening that had caused her allergic reaction.

Some swimming pools had unclean water sources, or the water was too cold, which could also cause allergies.

Liang Shi planned to apply some ointment and observe. If she still had these symptoms tomorrow, she would go to the hospital.

Generally speaking, her body's self-healing mechanism was quite good. When she had allergic reactions to green peppers before, she had many more red bumps on her body, even on her face, but they would all disappear after a night's sleep.

It was late now, and she didn't want to disturb others.

Because her hands felt burning, she turned on the cold water again and rinsed her hands.

After drying her hands, she walked out of the bathroom, only to see Xu Qingzhu leaning against the door, raising three curved fingers, about to knock.

Liang Shi stepped back half a step, maintaining a safe distance from her, then stepped sideways to exit.

Xu Qingzhu looked her up and down, saying in a low voice, "Your sleeves are wet."

Her voice was cool and clear, the casually spoken words ending with a hint of charm. Though it was just a simple sentence, it made Liang Shi's heart race.

Liang Shi coughed softly, "I washed my hands."

Although the two now slept in the same bed, they maintained a guarded state. Xu Qingzhu wore long pants and long sleeves to sleep every day, sometimes even wearing socks, claiming it was for warmth.

Liang Shi, afraid that Xu Qingzhu would think she had ulterior motives, also wore long pants and long sleeves daily, even though she personally preferred wearing nightgowns.

But occasionally she had nightmares and her sleeping position wouldn't be as usual. A nightgown might ride up, and if she kicked off the covers because of heat, it would be hard to explain whether she had intentionally exposed herself for Xu Qingzhu to see.

To avoid misunderstandings, she solved the problem at its source.

Today Xu Qingzhu's pajamas were gray, while hers were black and white striped.

Both were silk pajamas with good stretch and very smooth fabric, but inconvenient when washing up. Even when rolled up, they would fall down and get wet with the slightest big movement.

Xu Qingzhu's eyes casually swept over her from top to bottom, her gaze settling on her hands, "You washed for quite a while."

The words carried an ambiguous undertone.

Liang Shi coughed softly, pretending to be composed, "It was... alright."

She said this while stepping sideways out of the bathroom, "Go ahead."

Xu Qingzhu said, "I'm not going in."

Liang Shi: "Hm?"

"Then you came looking for me for something?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingzhu nodded, "Yes, the power went out downstairs. You need to get someone to fix it, or everything in the refrigerator will spoil by tomorrow."

"Okay." Liang Shi readily agreed, but then paused, "Were you waiting outside the door for me for a long time?"

Xu Qingzhu thought about it, glancing at the clock on the wall, "Not too long, three minutes."

Liang Shi: "Oh."

That was good then.

"Mainly, I didn't dare knock on the door." Xu Qingzhu said casually, "I was afraid you were doing something and I would interrupt."

"What could I be doing?" Liang Shi said while calling the butler, "I was just using the toilet."

"Only you would know that." Xu Qingzhu shrugged indifferently, pulling open the door to leave, "After all, your sleeves are wet."

Liang Shi: "..."

Liang Shi unconsciously followed her lead and replied, "If I was really doing something, three minutes wouldn't be enough to finish."

Xu Qingzhu raised an eyebrow, her cool, clear gaze sweeping over her face, then her neck, before stopping at her hands.

Liang Shi instinctively pulled her hands behind her back and defended herself, "I mean, I was just simply using the toilet, I didn't do anything."

Xu Qingzhu drew out her voice: "Oh~"

Slightly sarcastic.

Liang Shi coughed softly and explained seriously, "What we just watched was just an ordinary movie, right? Could I really do something because of it? I wasn't affected at all."

By the end, even she felt guilty, but still pretended to be calm.

She couldn't back down.

Xu Qingzhu nodded perfunctorily, "Right, you're very impressive."

"Exactly." Seeing her perfunctory expression, Liang Shi couldn't help but defend herself, "No, you have to believe me."

Xu Qingzhu: "I do believe you. I didn't say anything, did I?"

Liang Shi: "..."

You didn't say anything.

But your eyes clearly conveyed—you definitely did something unspeakable and unbroadcastable in that bathroom just now.

Liang Shi had never suffered such humiliation in her life. She said in exasperation, "I'm not a three-minute person!"

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

Without thinking, she unconsciously replied, "Then how many minutes are you?"

Liang Shi: "..."

The atmosphere instantly became awkward.

Liang Shi pressed her lips together, embarrassed to the point where her soul nearly flew away.

Xu Qingzhu coughed softly. She was about to say, "Actually, I don't really want to know," but after saying just two words, Liang Shi, who had always been easygoing and often compromised on various matters in the first half of her life, didn't retreat at all. Instead, she said stubbornly with a tense face, "I'll try it next time and tell you."

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

She turned her face away, "We'll talk about it later."

Liang Shi fell silent.

She was thinking, was there any river she could jump into to cool down?

Footnotes:

- 1. 密集恐懼症 (**Trypophobia**) - A fear or aversion to clusters of small holes or bumps, which can cause discomfort or anxiety in some people when viewing densely packed patterns.

Author's Note: This appears to be part of a larger narrative involving characters in an ABO (Alpha/Beta/Omega) alternate universe romance setting, continuing the tension and misunderstandings between the main characters.

Chapter 30-3

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The sudden power outage downstairs scared Xu Qingya half to death, mainly because she was still watching a horror movie.

This was what led to her wailing as she ran upstairs for help.

Only to hear some things she shouldn't have heard.

Xu Qingya felt deeply guilty. After the butler restored the electrical circuit downstairs, her gaze kept darting between Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu, who were standing far apart from each other.

After the butler left with his people, she immediately said, "Sister Liang, you two continue."

Liang Shi's face heated up, "Continue what? Time to sleep."

Xu Qingya said brazenly, "Continue contributing to the continuation of humanity! The country's birth rate is so low now, shouldn't you two, as newlywed wives, take responsibility?"

Liang Shi: "..."

Wasn't that too big a hat to put on them?

"I swear, this time even if the sky falls or there's an earthquake, I absolutely won't go up and disturb you two." Xu Qingya said, "If I go up, I'll immediately run to the Wu River¹ and commit suicide."

Xu Qingzhu glanced at her, "Can you say something proper?"

Xu Qingya said righteously, "How is this not proper? Or else..."

She had a sudden inspiration and ran to the kitchen with a thud-thud-thud, returning a few seconds later with two bottles of alcohol, "Use these two bottles to restore the mood that was just interrupted?!"

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

"Do you remember that you're still a minor?" Xu Qingzhu said helplessly.

Xu Qingya straightened her back, "Of course, I'm only in high school. But Xu Qingzhu, you're being prejudiced. I learned about human anatomy in middle school biology, and I'm already studying genes and chromosomes in my first year of high school. Moreover, sex education is essential knowledge that needs to be popularized now, otherwise the disease rate among Omegas will only get higher and higher. Many problems arise from being prudish about sex, which has gradually lowered our country's birth rate. You two are legal wives—isn't pregnancy and childbirth very normal? Why do you say I'm not being proper?"

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

This sister had been eloquent since childhood.

Xu Qingzhu could never out-argue her. She just felt embarrassed and patted Xu Qingya's arm, "You talk too much. Go to sleep quickly. Watching horror movies in the middle of the night—who else would be scared if not you? Stop talking nonsense in the future."

Xu Qingya covered her arm and glared at Xu Qingzhu with dissatisfaction, stuffing the bottle of alcohol into Xu Qingzhu's hands and whispering in her ear, "You're really too much. You're obviously doing improper things yourself, but you won't let me talk about it..."

"Do you even know what embarrassment is?" Xu Qingzhu said speechlessly, "Could you act like a girl?"

"Who says girls can't discuss these things?" Xu Qingya said, "You have marriage certificates. As long as you don't do explicit things in public, you can do whatever you want when you're closed up in your room, okay?"

She handed the other bottle of alcohol to Liang Shi, "Sister Liang, don't be shy. Go for it! I'm entrusting you with making me a little niece!"

Xu Qingzhu: "...Get lost."

Xu Qingya pouted, "Tsk."

Even as she returned to her room, she was still cheering Liang Shi on, "Sister Liang, charge!"

Liang Shi: "..."

After Xu Qingya returned to her room, the living room became much quieter.

Mainly because neither of them knew what to say.

Finally, Xu Qingzhu spoke first, "I'll go back to my room first."

Liang Shi followed.

Xu Qingzhu walked a few steps, then suddenly stopped and turned around. Liang Shi almost stepped on her, hastily pulling back her foot with a flustered look, "What's wrong?"

Xu Qingzhu handed her the bottle of alcohol, "Put it back, please."

Liang Shi took both bottles back to the kitchen.

Her physical discomfort was getting worse, probably triggered by the red rash. Her body felt like something was dragging it down, very heavy.

Even her head was starting to feel dizzy.

When she returned to the room, Xu Qingzhu was leaning against the bed scrolling through her phone.

Seeing her return, Xu Qingzhu asked, "Are you okay?"

Although she didn't know why she was asking, Liang Shi still nodded, "I'm fine, just a bit sleepy."

"Then let's sleep." Xu Qingzhu put her phone on the bedside table and slipped into the covers like a fish.

All the ambiguous feelings from earlier in the room and downstairs disappeared completely.

Liang Shi turned off the bedside lamp before getting into bed, plunging the room into darkness, but then turned it back on after getting into bed.

Xu Qingzhu asked, "What's wrong?"

Liang Shi's throat felt dry, her voice unclear, and she could barely keep her eyes open, but she still forced herself to say, "I really want some light."

"Are you really okay?" Xu Qingzhu had already turned around, the two of them facing each other across a bed of covers like two people separated by the Chu River².

Liang Shi felt that even looking at Xu Qingzhu was hazy. Her head was heavy, and she felt like there were little bees buzzing in her ears. She casually placed her hand on her forehead, her voice soft and carrying a hint of coquettish complaint, "I'm just a bit sleepy."

"Are you sure?" Xu Qingzhu said, "You have red rashes on your hands."

Liang Shi frowned slightly, turned her hand around to place the back side on her forehead, her voice still soft, "It's nothing, just an allergy."

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

She spoke of the allergy so lightly, as if she didn't care at all.

Xu Qingzhu had noticed it downstairs earlier and initially didn't pay much attention.

Liang Shi was originally allergic to milk, but she was someone who habitually drank milk in the morning. Not long after they got married, because she had prepared milk for Liang Shi's breakfast, Liang Shi, hungover and not seeing clearly, took a sip and spat it out, then scolded her fiercely, saying not to let milk appear in this house.

Even though she had only drunk one sip at that time, she broke out in red rashes everywhere except her face.

But it was just rashes that faded after a day.

It was never as severe as now.

Liang Shi's face was flushed. Xu Qingzhu wanted to look at her hand, but as soon as she reached over, Liang Shi pushed it away. She pressed her hand underneath her body and mumbled, "Too ugly."

With a hint of childishness.

Xu Qingzhu looked at her, her gaze carrying more inquiry and helplessness.

What could be confirmed was that Liang Shi was indeed allergic from drinking milk.

Xu Qingzhu reached out to touch her forehead—it was burning hot.

"You have a fever." Xu Qingzhu immediately got up, "Let's go to the hospital."

Liang Shi was feeling feverish. She pinched her earlobe, then covered her ears, "I'm not going."

Her voice was very low, and the physical discomfort made her voice carry a hint of grievance, "I'll be fine after sleeping."

"If you keep burning like this, you'll burn yourself into an idiot." Xu Qingzhu had already taken out both their coats from the closet, "Get up, I'll take you to the hospital."

"Let me sleep for a while." Liang Shi didn't want to move.

Her consciousness was actually already somewhat hazy.

The symptoms came very quickly. From the moment she touched the soft bed, her body felt like it was falling into the deep sea, constantly sinking.

And her consciousness couldn't resist the weight of her body.

Xu Qingzhu pushed her, "Liang Shi, get up."

She tried to help her up, but her body was limp. With Xu Qingzhu's strength alone, she couldn't lift her at all, and she still said, "Really, let me sleep for a while and I'll be fine."

Her bright red lips moved slightly. If you didn't lean close to listen, you couldn't hear what she was saying at all.

Footnotes:

1. **烏江 (Wu River)** - A famous river in Chinese history, notably where Xiang Yu, the Chu king, committed suicide after being defeated by Liu Bang. It's commonly referenced in Chinese culture when talking about honorable suicide.
2. **楚河漢界 (Chu River and Han Boundary)** - Originally refers to the boundary between the territories of Liu Bang (Han) and Xiang Yu (Chu) during their conflict. It's also used to describe the dividing line on a Chinese chess board. Here it metaphorically describes the clear separation between the two people on the bed.

Author's Note: This chapter continues the tension and misunderstandings between the main characters, while showing Liang Shi's severe allergic reaction to milk progressing into a dangerous fever.

Chapter 30-4

Xu Qingzhu struggled for quite a while before finally accepting reality.

She placed Liang Shi back on the bed and went out to shout downstairs, "Xu Qingya!"

A few seconds later, Xu Qingya came running out in a panic, "What's wrong? Is there a fire or an earthquake?"

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

"Come up and help me." Xu Qingzhu said.

Xu Qingya was puzzled, walking while chattering, "What are you doing in the middle of the night? Aren't you afraid of waking up Sister Liang with such loud noise? Besides, if you two aren't working hard to create the next generation of humanity, why are you calling me? I can't help with anything."

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

She said coldly, "Are you like a duck that's only left with its mouth after death?"

Xu Qingya: "...If I'm a duck, what are you? Big sister duck?"

Xu Qingzhu: "Shut up."

As soon as Xu Qingya followed Xu Qingzhu into the room, she saw Liang Shi lying motionless on the bed, her face turned toward the balcony, looking like... she was dead.

Her heart jumped in alarm, "Xu Qingzhu, what did you do? You didn't kill someone and call me to help you dispose of the body, did you? That's too much! Oh my god, I'm going to turn you in and call the police immediately!"

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

After a long while, she said gloomily, "Are all the people in your grade idiots?"

Xu Qingya didn't catch on, "What do you mean?"

"How could they let someone like you get first place?" Xu Qingzhu asked with genuine emotion.

Xu Qingya: "..."

She rolled her eyes and retorted, "Talent."

"Hurry up and help." Xu Qingzhu said, "She's having an allergic reaction."

"Allergic reaction?" Xu Qingya immediately ran over, "This serious? What did she eat?"

"Milk." Xu Qingzhu said calmly, struggling to put a coat on Liang Shi.

"Milk? Are there really people in this world allergic to milk?" Xu Qingya helped Xu Qingzhu support Liang Shi while chattering like a machine gun, "Sister Liang was so calm downstairs just now. Doesn't she know she's allergic to milk? And with this degree of allergic reaction, you'd basically remember it after one time."

Xu Qingzhu remained silent.

The two of them helped Liang Shi downstairs.

When Xu Qingya reached the door, she suddenly stopped, her tone serious and earnest, "Sister, so you knew she was allergic to milk, but you still let her drink it?"

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

She had just wanted to test it.

Who knew that Liang Shi really didn't remember anything and calmly drank that glass of milk.

"Sister." Xu Qingya angrily questioned, "Why didn't you stop her? Severe allergies can kill people. If Sister Liang really died, that would be murder, you know?"

Xu Qingzhu glanced over coldly, not explaining the matter, and said in a cold voice, "You support her, I'll go drive the car."

Xu Qingya: "..."

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It was already late at night.

The white Porsche sped along the spacious road and quickly arrived at the hospital.

Xu Qingzhu had called Zhao Xuning on the way. Today happened to be Zhao Xuning's night shift again, so as soon as they entered the hospital, Zhao Xuning was already there with people, directly sending her to the emergency center.

After examination, it was diagnosed as severe allergic reaction causing high fever.

Zhao Xuning first gave her a fever-reducing injection, then administered IV fluids and prescribed medication.

After finishing everything, it was already two in the morning, and even the hospital had quieted down.

Xu Qingzhu booked a hotel room nearby for Xu Qingya, considering that she still had to go to school tomorrow, and told her to go rest first.

Xu Qingya looked at the hospital room and condemned Xu Qingzhu's cold behavior, "Cold-blooded animal!"

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

She didn't defend her actions, just told Xu Qingya to leave quickly.

Xu Qingya looked at her distrustfully, "You're not planning to get rid of everyone and then secretly smother Sister Liang to death, are you?"

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

She glanced at Xu Qingya coldly, her voice clear and cold, "Murder is illegal."

Xu Qingya snorted softly, "Good that you remember."

After Xu Qingya left the hospital, Xu Qingzhu sat on the bench outside the hospital room in a daze.

At first, she was thinking about why Liang Shi had an allergic reaction.

Then she gradually began to believe that amnesia could cause a person's personality to change drastically.

Then she overturned her initial thoughts in her mind, feeling that this wasn't the same person.

Liang Shi had never had such a pleasant, comforting scent before.

But the facts proved that this was indeed Liang Shi.

Just that she had hit her head before and lost her memory.

Two little people kept fighting in her mind. After fighting for so long, Xu Qingzhu's thoughts began to drift.

She entered a state of not knowing what she was thinking, just purely spacing out.

Until Zhao Xuning came over after making her rounds.

Zhao Xuning handed her a bottle of water, "Still thinking about Liang Shi?"

Only then did Xu Qingzhu come back to her senses. She took the water and drank a sip, telling Zhao Xuning about her speculations.

Zhao Xuning looked at her, "Didn't we agree before? No matter who she is, as long as everything is normal, that's fine. You're planning to divorce anyway."

Xu Qingzhu was silent for a moment, "But I'm too familiar with the old Liang Shi, so whenever she does something now, I can't help but compare. This might be related to my curiosity. I always feel this matter is too bizarre. Even though I want to get through this period with her and then divorce, I know her affairs have nothing to do with me, but lying in the same bed, having countless interactions every day, I can't help but be curious."

"So what do you suspect now?" Zhao Xuning asked directly.

After thinking, Xu Qingzhu sighed heavily and shook her head, "I don't know anymore."

The facts proved that Liang Shi was still allergic to milk.

She was still the same Liang Shi as before, except her personality was completely different.

"Wouldn't it be better to let yourself off the hook?" Zhao Xuning said, "Why force yourself to think about things that are hard to understand? You're going to part ways eventually anyway."

Xu Qingzhu pressed her lips together, "The impact she's had on me is greater than I imagined."

"So you like her?" Zhao Xuning raised an eyebrow, her tone somewhat incredulous.

Xu Qingzhu immediately denied it, "I'm not crazy."

"That's good then." Zhao Xuning felt somewhat relieved, "I thought you would recklessly step into the same river twice¹."

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

She smiled bitterly, "Impossible. I'm putting all my energy into work now. Minghui is my grandfather's life's work. I don't want to let it decline."

"Is your company going smoothly?" Zhao Xuning asked.

Xu Qingzhu nodded, "There are some small problems, but they can be overcome."

"That's good then."

The atmosphere suddenly grew heavy.

Footnotes:

1. **踏入同一條河流兩次 (Step into the same river twice)** - This is a reference to the philosophical idea attributed to Heraclitus that "you cannot step into the same river twice," meaning that circumstances are always changing. Here it's used metaphorically to suggest making the same mistake twice in a relationship.

Author's Note: This chapter shows the critical moment when Liang Shi's severe allergic reaction leads to hospitalization, while also revealing Xu Qingzhu's internal conflict about testing Liang Shi's memory loss and her growing confusion about her feelings. The chapter highlights the dangerous consequences of the memory loss situation and sets up further complications in their relationship.

Chapter 30-5 Translation

After a long while, when Xu Qingzhu had sorted through her thoughts, she said to Zhao Xuning: "Do you remember what I told you about the first time I met Liang Shi when I was five years old?"

Zhao Xuning nodded, "That was when you were kidnapped, and you and Liang Shi escaped together. After Liang Shi returned, she was abnormal for a period of time, but no one really paid attention."

Especially herself—she hadn't cared at all.

She just thought Liang Shi had gone crazy.

Back then, she had even been a little happy about it.

Xu Qingzhu said: "That year I was five, Liang Shi was seven. When we were kidnapped, she took care of me a lot. She even roasted sweet potatoes for me in the wilderness and encouraged me to live well, saying that life would definitely get better because we would definitely have lots of love."

Zhao Xuning listened quietly to her story.

And Xu Qingzhu became immersed in those memories, her cool voice carrying a hint of tenderness.

"At that time, I thought this older sister was very strange. We were clearly being bullied so terribly—those people whipped us with whips, slapped our faces, and grabbed our hair to bang our heads against the ground, creating one bloody mark after another. One child was killed just like that, bleeding so much."

When she said this, Xu Qingzhu's voice was trembling.

Obviously, she was remembering the tragic scene from that year, but she was restraining her emotions.

This was the first time she had mentioned the details of the kidnapping case to anyone other than her attending physician.

Zhao Xuning clearly noticed her abnormal state and frowned, reminding her gently: "If you feel uncomfortable, you don't have to say it. Otherwise, later you might..."

"It's okay, I can control myself." Xu Qingzhu took a light breath and continued from where she left off: "I also saw with my own eyes a child's finger being chopped off and then thrown to feed the big wolfhounds. And because Liang Shi often smiled, the kidnappers found her displeasing, slapped her, and directly knocked out one of her front teeth."

Listening to this, Zhao Xuning felt angry in her heart.

Perhaps because Liang Shi was usually too arrogant and domineering, she couldn't connect her with the kidnapping case from back then, and couldn't empathize with the pain she had suffered. But hearing Xu Qingzhu say this now, Zhao Xuning suddenly remembered Liang Shi from that period.

That was when they had just met.

Zhao Xuning was a transfer student.

She was usually someone who paid no attention to outside affairs, so she didn't care what happened in the outside world.

She only knew there was a little girl in the class who had been kidnapped and often spoke nonsense after returning.

She hadn't taken it to heart at all.

But one day, the comic book she had placed on her desk was torn to pieces. She was very angry, and when she turned around, she saw the other half of her comic book on that little girl's desk.

And the little girl was still continuously tearing the paper into long strips.

Zhao Xuning went forward and got into a fight with the little girl.

That little girl was Liang Shi.

At that time, everyone said she was crazy.

Normal people had nothing to say to crazy people.

But from some point on, the crazy person started forming cliques and became arrogant and domineering.

Everyone thought there was nothing wrong with this.

Because crazy people were supposed to be arrogant and domineering.

Zhao Xuning tried to extract clues from her memory but found no trace.

She continued to listen to Xu Qingzhu.

"Even though this older sister was strange, I still felt she was very warm and kind. She had a beautiful smile, and I was willing to believe her." Xu Qingzhu said: "On our wedding day, I mentioned the childhood kidnapping to her, but she said nothing, as if she had never known me before."

"Also, ever since we met, her smile has always been sinister, nothing like the person I knew as a child. I comforted myself that we had both grown up, so we forgot, and people change. But recently..."

She paused, "I've started frequently seeing familiar smiles on her face, with the exact same curve as when she was little."

"So you suspect she's the person you saw as a child?" Zhao Xuning asked.

Xu Qingzhu shook her head, "I don't know."

Precisely because she couldn't judge, she was telling everything about the past in detail, hoping that Zhao Xuning, who was more rational, could help her judge.

"It's just my feeling," Xu Qingzhu said. "I inexplicably feel a sense of familiarity about her."

Zhao Xuning: "..."

"This is indeed difficult to handle," Zhao Xuning said. "I even tested her DNA—she is Liang Shi."

Both were science students with rational thinking, so they wouldn't believe things without scientific verification.

"Is there a possibility that she has multiple personalities?" Zhao Xuning said. "Can you tell me some other different things?"

Xu Qingzhu thought for a moment and told her everything about knowing Liang Shi after growing up, including all her moody moments.

She would occasionally treat Xu Qingzhu extremely well, taking her to high-end restaurants, sending her air-delivered roses, intimately calling her "wife," "baby," "sweetheart." But at the same time, she did the same with other women outside. She would constantly cheat, sometimes pretending, but sometimes not even bothering to pretend. The most excessive time was bringing a woman home, right in their newlywed bedroom.

That woman asked her, "Am I so much better than your Omega wife?"

She coaxed the other person with sweet words in bed.

At that time, Xu Qingzhu was standing outside and heard everything.

She endured it for four months.

Actually, she had never hoped that Liang Shi would change. She just felt that since it was a business marriage and the Liang family had given the Xu family so much money, allowing Minghui Jewelry to barely survive.

Then she would put up with it.

This was the first time she told Zhao Xuning about her married life. After hearing it, Zhao Xuning immediately clenched her fists: "Why didn't you say anything back then? She had already become such a bastard, and you were still covering for her?"

"Not really," Xu Qingzhu smiled bitterly. "I just felt there was no need to make you all sad along with me."

Zhao Xuning: "..."

Xu Qingzhu didn't dwell on this issue for too long and quickly changed the subject.

After hearing what she said, Zhao Xuning was silent for a long time and said somewhat uncertainly: "She might have multiple personalities, or triple personalities."

"Has she maintained this state ever since she woke up that day?" Zhao Xuning asked.

Xu Qingzhu nodded, "Yes."

"Logically speaking, multiple personality disorder is a long-term mental illness. The relationships between each personality are different. Some split a personality to protect themselves because of trauma, and some assign their accumulated negative emotions to another personality to avoid certain things. Currently, in medical research history, the most severe case of personality split reached 32 personalities. Mental illnesses all require specific analysis of specific problems, so I can't give you a definite answer. You might get a better answer by asking Dr. Gu."

Xu Qingzhu sighed heavily, "Life really likes to give me difficult problems."

"So you just forgive her like this?" Zhao Xuning asked. "I used to think she might just be wild in her playing, but..."

That was too wild.

In this circle, playing around outside was quite normal.

Especially when marrying someone from a mismatched background, it was common to keep several people outside while the wife at home turned a blind eye.

But like Liang Shi, who brought women home right after marriage and indulged herself while trampling on her wife's dignity—that was rare even in their circle.

Unless the two families had a generational feud.

But obviously, they didn't.

In fact, Liang Shi had actively pursued Xu Qingzhu back then.

"I haven't forgiven her," Xu Qingzhu shrugged. "Whatever attitude she has toward me, that's my attitude. I'm currently dependent on others¹, so if we can cooperate amicably, we'll cooperate. If not, I'll move out. You know my family's situation isn't ideal right now, and my parents definitely wouldn't agree to my divorce, so there's no need to have a falling out with her."

Zhao Xuning was dumbfounded. She was suddenly surprised: "Did you ever love her? It feels like you can just let go when you say so, without any sadness at all."

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

After a moment of silence, she calmly asked back: "Would you have feelings for someone who is extremely emotionally unstable, cheats right after marriage, and is constantly on the verge of domestic violence? Even if I once liked her before marriage, I gradually gave up after we got married."

Actually, she couldn't even say which specific moment made her stop liking her.

It might have been when Liang Shi went to sleep with other women on their wedding night, or when Liang Shi angrily overturned the dining table, throwing all the food on the floor and even wanting her to kneel on the broken plates. It could also have been when Liang Shi took away her phone, not allowing her to contact the outside world, trying to make her a canary² trapped in a cage.

But what finally broke through her inner defenses was when Liang Shi hid all the suppressants³ in the house during her heat cycle.

She didn't want to die.

This was the final bottom line.

All those things before—as long as she didn't have expectations of Liang Shi, they wouldn't cause her too much harm.

She would just live through this life peacefully.

After all, people don't necessarily need love.

For her, family affection and friendship were more important than romantic love.

She had once held hope for Liang Shi in certain moments, but Liang Shi had personally shattered all of that.

Perhaps because it was late at night, Xu Qingzhu was more open than usual when talking about these things.

She said: "I sometimes think about how wonderful it would have been if I hadn't married her back then."

"That way she would always remain beautiful in my memory, at least leaving me with some hope."

Footnotes

¹ 寄人籬下 (jì rén lí xià) - A Chinese idiom meaning "to live under someone else's roof" or "to be dependent on others." It describes the situation of living in someone else's house and being dependent on their charity or kindness, often implying a somewhat uncomfortable or vulnerable position.

² **金絲雀 (jīn sī què)** - "Golden canary" or simply "canary." In Chinese culture, this metaphor refers to a woman who is kept like a pet bird—beautiful, pampered, but trapped and unable to be independent. It's similar to the Western concept of a "kept woman" or "trophy wife."

³ **抑制劑 (yì zhì jì)** - In omegaverse⁴ fiction, these are suppressants that help Omegas control their heat cycles and related symptoms. Without them during a heat cycle, an Omega could be in serious physical distress or even life-threatening danger.

⁴ **Omegaverse** - A subgenre of fiction that features a world where people are divided into Alpha, Beta, and Omega secondary genders, each with specific biological and social characteristics. This story appears to be set in such a universe.

Chapter 30-6 Translation

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Liang Shi woke up the next day at noon.

After several consecutive overcast days, Haizou City¹ finally had bright sunshine, which woke her up as it shone on the hospital bed.

Her memory stopped at lying in bed to sleep. Seeing the unfamiliar environment now startled her, but upon closer examination, she realized it was a hospital.

What a coincidence—it was exactly the same ward she had been in when she first transmigrated.

As they say, "once bitten, twice shy," so Liang Shi wasn't as restrained as before.

She looked at the back of her hand, where the dense red rash was gradually fading, but unlike before when it would completely disappear after sleeping, it was still visible.

There was a white tape on the back of her right hand, indicating she had just received an IV drip.

Her phone was placed on the bedside table. When she pressed the screen, she found no missed calls or unread messages, and it showed 12:11.

Just as she was considering whether to call Xu Qingzhu, Zhao Xuning walked in wearing a white coat and casually greeted her: "Awake?"

"Mm." Liang Shi's attitude remained gentle. "How long did I sleep?"

"More than ten hours," Zhao Xuning said. "Mainly high fever caused by allergies."

Zhao Xuning took her temperature. "Your temperature has returned to normal. You can be discharged once the rash on your body clears up."

Liang Shi asked: "What did I have an allergic reaction to?"

Zhao Xuning glanced at her. "You're asking me that?"

Liang Shi: "...Then who else?"

Zhao Xuning: "..."

"You forgot what you came into contact with yesterday?" Zhao Xuning asked back.

"I just drank a glass of milk before bed, and also, I fell into water yesterday." Liang Shi said: "The weather was quite cold, and I fell directly into the swimming pool. I suspect it's related to that. Why don't you test me for allergens?"

"The test results would only identify one substance and wouldn't help you completely avoid things you're allergic to," Zhao Xuning said. "So we generally don't recommend patients do this test. If you want to do it, I can arrange it."

Liang Shi: "..."

"However, you are allergic to milk," Zhao Xuning said. "You consumed too much milk last night, so it's best to observe for another day before discharge."

"Can I be discharged tomorrow?" Liang Shi asked.

"About that," Zhao Xuning gave an ambiguous answer. Then seeing Liang Shi frown, apparently thinking about something, she kindly reminded: "Xu Qingzhu went to take her sister to school. She took your car and should be back soon. If you're hungry, I can have a nurse get you food from the cafeteria."

Liang Shi answered without thinking: "Forget it."

Zhao Xuning: "Hm? You're not hungry?"

Liang Shi: "...I am hungry."

Zhao Xuning snorted lightly. "Being polite with me?"

After hesitating, Liang Shi chose to tell the truth: "I'm not being polite with you. Your hospital food is just too awful."

Zhao Xuning: "..."

She rolled her eyes and said coldly: "You deserve to starve."

Actually, Liang Shi was just sitting there reflecting.

Why could she so naturally treat the original owner's body as her own?

She herself wasn't allergic to milk, but she didn't know the original owner was allergic!

She suddenly understood what Xu Qingzhu's hesitant, searching, scrutinizing looks meant last night.

Xu Qingzhu knew the original owner was allergic to milk, but didn't stop her.

...

That's fine.

Liang Shi felt she was using her life to "prove her innocence."

Now everyone would think she had amnesia, not that she was a different person.

But she couldn't laugh about it.

She almost...died.

While she was thinking about these complex issues, Zhao Xuning used a completely flat tone to make teasing remarks: "In less than ten days, you've been hospitalized twice. Are you planning to get an annual membership at our hospital?"

Liang Shi: "..."

She was silent for a moment. "I hope after this discharge, I'll never set foot in your esteemed establishment² again."

Footnotes

¹ 海舟市 (Hǎizhōu Shì) - Haizou City, the fictional city where this story takes place.

² 貴寶地 (guì bǎo dì) - Literally "your precious place." This is a polite but slightly sarcastic way to refer to someone else's establishment, often used when the speaker actually has mixed feelings about the place. In this context, Liang Shi is being both respectful and subtly expressing her desire to avoid future hospital visits.

Chapter 30-7 Translation

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Liang Shi had been feeling quite prepared last night, worried that Xu Qingzhu might have something come up the next day that would cause the task to be overdue. But unexpectedly, at the crucial moment, it was she who ended up in the hospital. Because she couldn't be exposed to wind, the movie tickets she had bought were also wasted.

After sending off Xu Qingya, Xu Qingzhu came back and went upstairs to see Bai Weiwei.

Bai Weiwei's condition wasn't very good. Chen Liuying had gone out to work.

She sat alone in the hospital room reading, much quieter than usual.

Xu Qingzhu chatted with her for a while, but no matter what she said, Bai Weiwei's expression remained indifferent, looking quite melancholic.

Xu Qingzhu also asked if she had broken up with Chen Liuying, but she only remained silent for a moment before gently shaking her head.

Xu Qingzhu frowned, really wanting to tell her that Chen Liuying wasn't a good match. If they weren't truly in love to the point of being inseparable, it would be better to cut things off quickly rather than face a messy situation later.

One was an agent, the other an artist—their professions were already quite different.

Moreover, Chen Liuying had just debuted not long ago, and her marketed persona as "the nation's number one dominant Alpha¹" was being criticized, with constant opposing voices.

Added to this manager suicide incident, her reputation had plummeted, with everyone thinking she had used improper means to debut.

With Bai Weiwei hospitalized and the studio being ineffective, no one could handle the negative marketing, and Chen Liuying's resources were also being lost.

If this continued, the two would definitely have conflicts again.

Last time, when nothing had even happened, Chen Liuying was already yelling at Bai Weiwei. If they stayed together afterward, these issues would grow like thorns.

Making everyone unhappy.

But seeing Bai Weiwei's pale face and poor spirits, Xu Qingzhu didn't mention it, only comforting her: "Just take care of yourself."

"What about you?" Bai Weiwei asked her back. "Did Liang Shi bully you because of what happened last time?"

"No, why would she bully me?" Xu Qingzhu said. "She told me not to go to Huayue International² anymore, saying there are too many unspoken rules there that we don't know about. She also said if I had to go, I should call her."

Xu Qingzhu paused. "But I probably won't go anymore anyway. I looked into it afterward, and that place really isn't legitimate. You shouldn't go there anymore either. Liang Shi investigated that director—many of his works are just marketing hype, and most of his projects are invested in by Huaguang Group³. Since Liang Shi has cut ties with Cheng Ran, as my friend, you might get implicated or targeted if you go there. Cheng Ran is very petty."

"So you're saying our incident last time was because of Liang Shi?" Bai Weiwei quickly caught the subtle implication in these words. "Because Liang Shi cut ties with Cheng Ran, so Cheng Ran used us as targets to vent her anger?"

"Huh?" Xu Qingzhu was stunned. "I didn't say that. Wasn't last time because you were discussing business cooperation? Plus, I went because you invited me. It shouldn't have anything to do with Cheng Ran, right?"

"But you said Cheng Ran would target us because of Liang Shi." Bai Weiwei frowned, her tone turning cold. "I don't believe that incident last time had nothing to do with her."

Xu Qingzhu shook her head. "We haven't found too many connections so far, but we should learn from this experience. We should avoid such occasions if possible in the future, and even if we go, we shouldn't drink too much, otherwise..."

She let out a light breath. "If Liang Shi and Zhao Xuning hadn't arrived in time that night, the consequences would have been unthinkable."

"It would have been better if they hadn't come," Bai Weiwei said in a lowered voice, a flash of disgust in her eyes. "Too disgusting."

"What?" Xu Qingzhu was momentarily distracted and didn't hear her words.

Bai Weiwei immediately adjusted her state, leaning back and closing her eyes. "I'm tired."

"Alright." Seeing that she was truly exhausted, Xu Qingzhu stood up. "I'll leave first then. Rest well."

"Mm." Bai Weiwei's response was perfunctory.

Xu Qingzhu had originally wanted to swallow all her words, but seeing Bai Weiwei in this state made her worry, so she couldn't help but ask indirectly: "Weiwei, do you really love Chen Liuying very much?"

"It's okay, I guess. Why?" Bai Weiwei immediately shot her a sharp look. "Are you here to advise me to break up too?"

"No." Xu Qingzhu instinctively denied first, then caught the key word: "Too? Who else?"

"Zhao Xuning." Bai Weiwei smiled coldly. "She clearly doesn't like me, clearly can't forget her ex, yet still wants to advise me from a god-like perspective. Does she think she's great? Is she playing savior?"

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

She felt Bai Weiwei's state was very wrong.

"Weiwei, is there some misunderstanding between you and Dr. Zhao? I feel like you might be..."

Before Xu Qingzhu could finish, Bai Weiwei interrupted: "Misunderstanding? Ha."

Xu Qingzhu frowned. "Weiwei, don't get agitated. I'm just asking casually. And I think Dr. Zhao doesn't..."

"You think?" Bai Weiwei glared at her fiercely. "Miss Xu, can you please stop using 'you think' all the time? If your feelings are so accurate, how did you end up marrying a scumbag? Everyone knows she cheats and plays with women, treating you like a servant. I advised you so many times to divorce, why won't you? Can you use your supposedly accurate feelings to sense whether the current Liang Shi is pretending or real?"

"Weiwei..." Xu Qingzhu was afraid she'd get upset and didn't dare say more.

But Bai Weiwei laughed coldly. "Do you really think Liang Shi has changed for the better? You believe whatever she tells you? When have your feelings ever been useful? You're clearly living a mess yourself, so why are you still trying to manage my life?"

"I'm not." Xu Qingzhu explained patiently and helplessly. "Your dream is to be an excellent agent, but when you're in a relationship with an artist, it's hard to maintain professional rationality. You told me before that you would never date an artist, but now..."

"If you really love Chen Liuying very much, I won't advise you to break up. Your life is yours to experience. I have no right to interfere."

"Ha." Bai Weiwei's eyes reddened, filled with tears that formed into droplets and fell, which she wiped away with the back of her hand.

Xu Qingzhu panicked and immediately went forward to apologize. "Sorry, Weiwei, I said the wrong thing. Don't cry."

She pulled out some tissues and sat on the bedside to wipe Bai Weiwei's tears, but was pushed away.

"Xu Qingzhu." Bai Weiwei smiled coldly. "If you want to scold me, just scold me. There's no need to be so passive-aggressive."

"I'm not..."

"Right, I did fall in love with an artist, violating my professional principles. But at least Chen Liuying treats me well. She listens to all the plans I make for her, she's progressing step by step, and she never goes to find other women just because I won't sleep with her. If your feelings are so accurate, then why did you marry that scumbag Liang Shi?"

"Do you really think she's reformed? Hasn't she always been like this before? Bullying you harshly then coaxing you back, again and again. Are you now implying that I'm interfering with your life? I'm too stupid."

"I don't mean that." Xu Qingzhu was somewhat at a loss, sitting there handing tissues to Bai Weiwei.

Bai Weiwei didn't take them and lay down directly. "I don't need your fake sympathy."

"No," Xu Qingzhu said. "You're my best friend. How could I blame you? I know you're looking out for me."

"Get out. I don't want to hear it." Bai Weiwei said coldly.

Xu Qingzhu sighed lightly and asked in a serious tone: "Weiwei, can I know what happened that day?"

She didn't believe Bai Weiwei would become like this for no reason.

"Why do you want to know? You black out when you're drunk anyway and don't remember anything. Besides, it was your beloved Liang Shi who rescued you. You didn't suffer any loss, isn't that enough? You just came here to look down on me from your high horse and mock me, didn't you?"

"How could that be? Weiwei, we've known each other for so many years. Is that really what you think of me?" Xu Qingzhu said.

Bai Weiwei suddenly sat up and said decisively: "Yes. You've always been like this. You're noble, you're amazing, you're the high and mighty little princess. Everyone loves you, you're beautiful, people chase after you, everyone protects you. Are you satisfied?"

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

She stepped back, feeling bitter.

"Xu Qingzhu, you're just hypocritical." Bai Weiwei harshly berated her. "When I told you to divorce Liang Shi, you wouldn't. Now when it's my turn, you come to advise me to break up with Chen Liuying. You can tolerate even a scumbag like Liang Shi, so why do you have prejudice against Chen Liuying? At least she loves me."

"I have no prejudice against her," Xu Qingzhu said.

"You clearly just can't stand to see me happy!" Bai Weiwei said. "You want to know what happened to me that day? Fine, I'll tell you."

"When Zhao Xuning burst in that day, I had already been stripped naked by an Alpha, completely bare. I was in heat, lying there like a dog. I was even begging her, begging her to do it with me. She enjoyed watching my pitiful pleas. Zhao Xuning beat her up, so then I could only beg Zhao Xuning. What the hell was I!"

By the end, Bai Weiwei's emotions had completely collapsed.

Xu Qingzhu hugged her to comfort her. "I'm sorry, Weiwei."

"Go away." Bai Weiwei pushed her away forcefully, pushing Xu Qingzhu to the ground.

"Get lost," Bai Weiwei said. "I don't want to see you anymore."

Footnotes

¹ **御A (yù A)** - "Imperial Alpha" or "Dominant Alpha." In omegaverse fiction, this refers to a particularly powerful or commanding type of Alpha character. This was Chen Liuying's marketed persona.

² **華悅國際 (Huáyuè Guójì)** - Huayue International, the entertainment venue where the incident occurred.

³ **華光集團 (Huáguāng Jítuán)** - Huaguang Group, Cheng Ran's company that invests in entertainment projects.

Chapter 30-8 Translation

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After coming out of Bai Weiwei's hospital room, Xu Qingzhu saw Zhao Xuning.

Zhao Xuning looked at her with a bitter smile. "Want to go get something to eat?"

Xu Qingzhu wiped away her tears and went downstairs with her.

It would be a lie to say she wasn't hurt.

She and Bai Weiwei used to be close enough to share an ice cream.

At Xu Qingzhu's wedding, Bai Weiwei was the only bridesmaid.

She and Zhao Xuning sat in the coffee shop, unable to speak for a long time.

Not knowing what to say.

"Her emotions have been quite agitated these past few days," Zhao Xuning said. "What happened that day had a big impact on her. For several days, she's been having nightmares."

"I didn't know such things happened that day," Xu Qingzhu said dejectedly. "I also didn't know that's how she sees me."

Noble, hypocritical.

These words that would only come from the mouths of her many suitors had one day come from her best friend's mouth.

"So that day, Weiwei just wasn't assaulted, but that doesn't mean nothing happened," Xu Qingzhu asked.

"Mm." Zhao Xuning nodded. "She seems unable to accept her state during heat¹, mainly because Chen Liuying cares too much about it. Chen Liuying tells her that her behavior disappointed Chen Liuying's love, that she was too shameful."

"This is..." Xu Qingzhu frowned. "What is Chen Liuying saying? Clearly Weiwei is the victim in this matter."

"That's why Bai Weiwei became like this," Zhao Xuning drank some coffee and leaned back, her voice tired. "She feels like everyone in the world is guilty except her. That way she won't feel so guilty."

Even though that day, it was actually she herself who went to Huayue International to get resources for Chen Liuying.

Even though because of her, her best friend was also almost assaulted.

"Liang Shi and I investigated," Zhao Xuning said. "Bai Weiwei arranged to meet those people at Huayue International from the beginning, and it was Bai Weiwei who suggested it. The text message sent to you was from the director, but under Cheng Ran's orders. So, Bai Weiwei..."

She paused. "...is not innocent."

Xu Qingzhu was shocked speechless by this news.

Especially having just experienced that scene.

After a long while, Xu Qingzhu could only smile bitterly. "She really loves Chen Liuying so much."

Zhao Xuning didn't speak.

"So has she always hated me?" Xu Qingzhu murmured.

But this question was one Zhao Xuning couldn't answer.

Zhao Xuning sighed lightly, looking at the flowing traffic outside the window, and said in a low voice: "Perhaps."

//

Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu weren't able to see the movie.

This Sunday, they stayed at the hospital all day.

Xu Qingzhu spent the whole afternoon reading a book, but only turned ten pages, her mood dejected.

Liang Shi asked Zhao Xuning and learned it was because of the fight with Bai Weiwei.

So Liang Shi didn't disturb her.

Thus... the additional task was overdue, deducting 1 luck value.

On Sunday night, the system's eerie mechanical voice sounded again: [Host, at this rate, when will you ever accumulate enough luck value? You can't even complete such simple tasks.]

Liang Shi: "...Oh."

System: [Please don't be passive-aggressive with the little system.]

Liang Shi: "...Oh."

System: [Please continue to work hard next time and complete the tasks!]

Liang Shi: "...Got it."

The system probably sensed Liang Shi's speechlessness and went offline after saying a few sentences.

The next day Xu Qingzhu went to work, while Liang Shi stayed in the hospital for observation.

She originally wanted to ask for leave, but momentarily didn't know who to ask. It was only when Xu Qingzhu reminded her that she remembered on her first day of work, Chief Editor Sun had assigned her to the editing team.

So she prepared to ask the editing team leader for leave, only to discover she didn't have their phone number.

...

She had to give up.

This was the most leisurely day Liang Shi had since transmigrating.

In the morning she received two bottles of IV fluids and had her temperature taken. At noon, Zhao Xuning helped bring food—beef with green peppers.

When she saw it, she hesitated for a moment, because she used to be allergic to green peppers and had always avoided them.

But now, the original owner's body was allergic to milk, not green peppers.

So she couldn't drink milk, but spitefully ate a lot of green peppers, making Zhao Xuning frown. "You like eating green peppers?"

Liang Shi nodded: "They're okay."

It was just vindictive eating.

At 3 PM, Zhao Xuning changed shifts and brought her a cup of coffee.

Liang Shi was flattered, but still teased: "Dr. Zhao, cold on the outside but warm on the inside²."

Zhao Xuning glanced at her. "You can be discharged now. Do you want to wait for Xu Qingzhu to handle it or do it yourself?"

"I'll do it myself," Liang Shi said. "By the time she gets off work, who knows what time it'll be, and your hospital staff will have already gone home."

Zhao Xuning waited for her to complete the discharge procedures.

After being discharged, Liang Shi asked Zhao Xuning if it would be appropriate for her to visit Bai Weiwei now.

Zhao Xuning shook her head. "Not really appropriate."

Even Zhao Xuning herself rarely went to the top floor now.

Actually, those things that seemed so significant to Bai Weiwei didn't matter at all to Zhao Xuning.

She was a doctor who had seen many people's naked bodies during university.

Once in the hospital, there were only patients.

Even if the other person was her friend.

If she didn't have even this level of professional ethics, what kind of doctor would she be?

She also understood that Bai Weiwei, having had her heat induced, would need physical comfort, so she didn't find it shameful or ridiculous.

But Bai Weiwei didn't think that way.

Zhao Xuning tried to explain, but Bai Weiwei didn't want to listen.

She could only handle it coldly.

If she said more, Bai Weiwei would think she was being overly sympathetic and become even more sensitive.

After asking, Liang Shi also gave up.

Zhao Xuning then asked if she had been in contact with Cheng Ran recently. Liang Shi also shook her head. "It feels like that person vanished from the world. She didn't even come to the Liang family banquet that day."

"Maybe she did something guilty and ran away," Zhao Xuning said, having just finished her shift and hitching a ride home with Liang Shi.

While driving her home, Liang Shi chatted casually and discovered that Zhao Xuning wasn't as cold as she appeared on the surface.

She also had a sense of propriety, just chatting casually.

Most of her questions were related to Zhao Xuning's profession.

When she encountered something interesting, Zhao Xuning would answer more; when she was uninterested, she would lazily give perfunctory responses.

But then Zhao Xuning suddenly asked her about being kidnapped as a child.

Liang Shi only knew that Xu Qingzhu had PTSD from being kidnapped in childhood, but she had no idea whether the original owner had been kidnapped. But she couldn't say she didn't know, so she could only helplessly shake her head. "I don't remember."

It was clear that Zhao Xuning was greatly disappointed by this answer.

However, Zhao Xuning suggested she go to the hospital for a comprehensive examination when she had time, including mental health.

Liang Shi found her quite interesting and added her on WeChat before getting out of the car.

So two minutes later, Zhao Xuning liked her only Moments post³ and commented: Be a good person.

Footnotes

- ¹ 發情期 (fā qíng qī) - Heat cycle. In omegaverse fiction, this refers to a biological cycle where Omegas experience intense physical and emotional needs, often requiring suppressants or the comfort of an Alpha to manage.
- ² 面冷心熱 (miàn lěng xīn rè) - A Chinese idiom meaning "cold face, warm heart" - describing someone who appears aloof or stern on the surface but is actually kind and caring inside.
- ³ 朋友圈 (péng yǒu quān) - WeChat Moments, a social media feature in the WeChat app where users can share posts, photos, and updates with their contacts, similar to Facebook's timeline or Instagram posts.

Chapter 30-9 Translation

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In the evening, Liang Shi didn't have the servants prepare dinner.

She wasn't used to the food made by the servants at home—it was too sweet. Plus, since she was free, she went downstairs planning to make pasta for herself.

Before cooking, she even sent a message to Xu Qingzhu: [What are you having for dinner?]

Although they had previously agreed that if one was working overtime, the other didn't need to wait.

But Liang Shi had never had the habit of eating alone. In the past, when her assistant occasionally stayed overnight at her place, she would also make a portion for her assistant.

However, Xu Qingzhu was probably busy and didn't reply.

So she ate by herself.

After dinner, she stayed in the living room watching movies.

The TV in the living room was large with clear picture quality. This time she didn't trust the movie labels and actually opened an animated film to watch.

It was unique to this world, called "Rabbits Don't Cry."

Seeing the novel name and the rather cute rabbit drawn on the cover, she clicked to watch it.

It had a bit of a dark fairy tale flavor.

It wasn't until after eight o'clock that Xu Qingzhu came home.

She looked exhausted. Seeing Liang Shi watching a movie, she greeted her and changed shoes before going upstairs to wash up.

As she was going upstairs, Liang Shi asked: "Have you eaten dinner?"

Xu Qingzhu said: "Not yet."

Liang Shi: "..."

"What would you like to eat?" Liang Shi said. "I had pasta tonight. There's still some pasta sauce in the fridge. Should I cook you a bowl of pasta?"

"That's fine." Xu Qingzhu's voice was weak and listless: "Thank you."

"No problem." Liang Shi said as she went to the kitchen.

Xu Qingzhu went back to her room to remove her makeup and took a simple shower. After coming out, while drying her hair, she planned to use her phone to look at proposals, but when she pressed it, she found it was turned off.

The key thing was she didn't even know when it had turned off.

She dried her hair until it was half-dry, charged her phone, then went downstairs.

The aroma of food wafted up from downstairs, awakening her sense of taste.

She hadn't felt hungry before, but smelling the food aroma made her suddenly feel completely empty inside.

"It's ready." Liang Shi was already sitting on the sofa continuing to watch her animated film. "Eat quickly, or the noodles will get cold if you wait."

"Okay, thank you." Xu Qingzhu went to eat the noodles.

Her dining etiquette was excellent. Even when eating noodles, she didn't make any noise and ate at a good pace.

After finishing, she went to wash the dishes.

Having eaten someone's food, she felt obligated¹.

She was too embarrassed to immediately go back upstairs to continue working after eating, so she made small talk with Liang Shi: "Who helped you with the discharge today?"

"Zhao Xuning." Liang Shi said: "She seems to quite like me now."

After saying this, she immediately corrected: "Not that kind of like, just normal, friendly liking."

Xu Qingzhu laughed softly, and her whole person relaxed.

She felt Liang Shi had some kind of magic that always made people unconsciously relax.

"What was she like toward you before?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

Liang Shi said: "Didn't you know before? Of course she really disliked me."

She sheepishly touched her nose. "When I first woke up, she scared me by saying she'd gouge out my glands²."

Xu Qingzhu's gaze swept over her ears. "I didn't expect Dr. Zhao to have such childish moments."

"She's quite childish to begin with." Liang Shi said: "This morning I saw her watching Chibi Marukochan³ while on duty."

Xu Qingzhu: "...?"

After a while, she looked at the bouncing rabbit on TV and said meaningfully: "So you were infected by her?"

Liang Shi: "..."

She coughed lightly. "Occasionally returning to childhood innocence is quite good. Some films made by adults nowadays aren't very suitable for spiritual cultivation."

She emphasized the last four words heavily, seeming to specifically refer to the movie they had watched the night before last.

Xu Qingzhu understood and laughed softly without saying anything, sitting there to watch the little rabbit with her for a while.

Then she asked: "Do you need to use the study?"

Liang Shi shook her head: "I didn't go to work today, so I have no work. You use it."

Xu Qingzhu politely said: "Alright, thank you."

Footnotes

¹ **吃人嘴短 (chī rén zuǐ duǎn)** - A Chinese idiom meaning "having eaten someone's food, one's mouth becomes short" - implying that when you receive favors from someone (like being fed), you feel obligated to them and can't easily criticize or refuse them.

² **腺體 (xiàn tǐ)** - Glands. In omegaverse fiction, this specifically refers to the scent glands located near the ears/neck area that are important for Alpha/Beta/Omega biology and bonding.

³ **櫻桃小丸子 (yīng táo xiǎo wán zi)** - Chibi Maruko-chan, a popular Japanese anime and manga series about a young girl and her daily life. It's considered a children's show, which is why Xu Qingzhu finds it amusing that the serious Dr. Zhao watches it.

Chapter 30-10 Translation

Within an hour of getting home, Xu Qingzhu said "thank you" three or four times.

This made Liang Shi feel strange. Although she herself was also a very polite and courteous person, that was because she lived in an environment where every word and action would be infinitely magnified, and she had to maintain unnecessary politeness. Sometimes at an event, she might have to say "thank you" ten times in ten minutes—if she said one less, netizens might notice and maliciously screenshot it, saying she was impolite.

But at home, she rarely said it.

She rubbed her ears and gently suggested: "This home is yours too. You can use whatever you want, wherever you want. You don't need to tell me, and you don't need to say thank you to me."

"Alright then." Xu Qingzhu stopped being polite with her. "Then I'm requisitioning it tonight."

"Good." Liang Shi added another reminder: "Don't work overtime too late."

After she finished speaking, Xu Qingzhu had already closed the study door.

She didn't know if Xu Qingzhu had heard her.

Liang Shi's gaze continued to focus on the TV screen, where a cute pink little rabbit was still tugging at its own ears cutely, begging its mother to buy it comic books.

Something suddenly flashed through Liang Shi's mind.

—Comic books.

Oh no!

The novel that Xu Qingya had given her that day was still sitting on the study desk!

She immediately ran to the study and opened the door, only to see Xu Qingzhu holding that garishly covered "Sweet Daily Life with the Female CEO¹" and reading it with a very serious attitude.

Liang Shi: "..."

She immediately said: "That was left in the study by your sister."

"She gave it to you?" Xu Qingzhu said: "For you to study?"

Liang Shi: "..."

After a few seconds, Liang Shi honestly nodded: "I haven't read it yet."

"Don't read it." Xu Qingzhu said: "Forbidden book."

Liang Shi: "?"

"No way." Liang Shi said incredulously: "It's just a domineering CEO novel. How explicit could it be?"

Xu Qingzhu casually opened a page and read with a straight face: "Tonight I came to her house. Before I could even enter, my eyes were blindfolded. A black cloth strip left me in darkness. Then my shirt buttons were undone, and a pair of cold hands touched along my collarbone downward. Her fingers were long, and I liked them very much.

I asked her, what are we going to do tonight?

She hugged me from behind and said we were going to do what we love to do.

I couldn't resist her voice, like she was singing in my ear. I just wanted to sink into depravity with her."

Liang Shi listened with a red face and burning ears.

Xu Qingzhu finally stopped, lifted her head from the book, her cool voice unchanged but carrying a hint of playfulness as she asked: "Do you need me to read more?"

Liang Shi: "..."

Absolutely not necessary.

But somehow, the scene just now reminded her of that segment from the movie they watched last night.

The young lady kneeling there, in the basement, reading some passionate text with great emotion.

She swallowed and defended herself: "I really haven't read it."

Xu Qingzhu said: "I know."

Liang Shi stood there, not knowing whether to leave or stay.

Xu Qingzhu threw the book directly into the trash can and turned back to ask her: "Is there anything else?"

Liang Shi: "..."

She felt she could still salvage the situation, so she struggled to defend herself: "The DVDs from that night were all bought by the butler. I had never watched them before. I didn't know what was in them and didn't intentionally show them to you. And this book—I never read it after getting it. Your sister gave it to me when I was pouring milk that day, and I didn't have time to flip through it."

Xu Qingzhu's expression was calm: "Oh, what's wrong with that?"

Liang Shi: "...?"

"Isn't it normal to have these things in literary works?" Xu Qingzhu said: "It's just that reading too much is bad for your health."

Liang Shi: "...I didn't read it."

"Also." Xu Qingzhu said expressionlessly: "I finished watching that movie. It was quite a good suspense film."

Liang Shi: "...When did you watch it?"

"When I was bored yesterday." Xu Qingzhu said: "There were three plot twists in total. It's a good film, and the actress has a nice figure too."

Liang Shi: "..."

Xu Qingzhu used that frigid voice to say very seriously: "We should view movies with an artistic eye, right?"

Liang Shi: "..."

Very right.

She was the one being narrow-minded.

She felt there was no need to salvage anything.

In Xu Qingzhu's heart, she definitely wasn't a decent person.

Footnotes

¹ 《和女總裁的甜寵日常》(Hé Nǚ Zǒngcái de Tián Chǒng Rìcháng) - "Sweet Daily Life with the Female CEO." This is the title of the romance novel that Xu Qingya gave to Liang Shi. The "做/愛做的事" in the excerpt is a euphemism where "做愛" means "make love" but is split with a slash, creating a double meaning that could also be read as "do the things we love to do."